

Purpose: To help us consider the eternal inheritances in the three kingdoms of glory and encourage us to live so as to inherit celestial glory in God's presence with our families.

President Wilford Woodruff: "I will refer to the 'Vision' alone, as a revelation which gives more light, more truth, and more principle than any revelation contained in any other book we ever read. It makes plain to our understanding our present condition, where we came from, why we are here, and where we are going. Any man may know through that revelation what his part and condition will be." (The Discourses of Wilford Woodruff, sel. G. Homer Durham [1946], 47-48)

1. The kingdoms of glory and "the testimony of Jesus".

• D&C 76: Introduction, 11-24, 40-43, 119. †1. Account of the 'Vision' as recorded by Philo Dibble

†2. The Prophet Joseph Smith

Pondering: †3. President Marion G. Romney

"Joseph Smith's description of the vision begins and ends with a testimony of the Savior." (*Lesson Manual*)

"Each of us will inherit a kingdom of glory based on the manner in which we have 'received the testimony of Jesus' (D&C 76:51). (*LM*)

2. Perdition.

• D&C 76:25-39; 44-49. Satan is called Perdition.

Perdition—" [ME. *Perdicioun* < OFr. *Perdiciun* < ... L. *perdere*, to lose, ruin ...] 1. [Archaic] complete and irreparable loss; ruin 2. *Theol.* a) the loss of the soul; damnation b) same as HELL" (*New World Dictionary*, 1055)

• Revelation 12:7-9; D&C 29:36-37; 76:25-28; Moses 4:1-3.

†4. The Prophet Joseph Smith

• 1 Ne. 14:14; D&C 10:5; 27:15-18. What can we do to win the war against Satan in our lives?

3. The telestial kingdom.

• D&C 76:81-90, 98-106, 109-112; 1 Corinthians 15:40-41.

4. The terrestrial kingdom.

• D&C 76:71-80, 91, 97.

Elder Bruce R. McConkie: "Those destined to inherit the terrestrial kingdom are: (1) those who died 'without law'—those heathen and pagan people who do not hear the gospel in this life, and who would not accept it with all their hearts should they hear it; (2) those who hear and reject the gospel in this life and then accept it in the spirit world; (3) those 'who are honorable men of the earth, who [are] blinded by the craftiness of men'; and (4) those who are lukewarm members of the true church and who have testimonies, but who are not true and faithful in all things." (A New Witness for the Articles of Faith [1985], 146) †5. President Ezra Taft Benson

How can we keep ourselves from being "blinded by the craftiness of men"?

5. The celestial kingdom.

• D&C 76:50-70, 92-96; 131:1-4; 132:19-24; 137.

How does our testimony of Jesus determine the kingdom we will inherit after we die?

What does it mean to you to be valiant in the testimony of Jesus?

†6. Elder Bruce R. McConkie †7. The Prophet Joseph Smith

President Joseph Fielding Smith: "Section 76 of the Doctrine and Covenants in its sublimity and clearness in relation to the eternal destiny of the human family, has not been surpassed. It should be treasured by all members of the Church as a priceless heritage. It should strengthen their faith and be to them an incentive to seek the exaltation promised to all who are just and true. So plain and simple are its teachings that none should stumble or misunderstand." (Church History & Modern Revelation, 2:50)

†1. Account of the Vision as recorded by Philo Dibble:

“The vision which is recorded in the Book of Doctrine and Covenants was given at the house of ‘Father Johnson,’ in Hyrum [sic], Ohio, and during the time that Joseph and Sidney were in the spirit and saw the heavens open, there were other men in the room, perhaps twelve, among whom I was one during a part of the time—probably two-thirds of the time,—I saw the glory and felt the power, but did not see the vision.

“The events and conversation, while they were seeing what is written (and many things were seen and related that are not written,) I will relate as minutely as is necessary.

“Joseph would, at intervals, say: ‘What do I see?’ as one might say while looking out the window and beholding what all in the room could not see. Then he would relate what he had seen or what he was looking at. Then Sidney replied, ‘I see the same.’ Presently Sidney would say ‘What do I see?’ and would repeat what he had seen or was seeing, and Joseph would reply, ‘I see the same.’

“This manner of conversation was repeated at short intervals to the end of the vision, and during the whole time not a word was spoken by any other person. Not a sound nor motion made by anyone but Joseph and Sidney, and it seemed to me that they never moved a joint or limb during the time I was there, which I think was over an hour, and to the end of the vision.

“Joseph sat firmly and calmly all the time in the midst of a magnificent glory, but Sidney sat limp and pale, apparently as limber as a rag, observing which, Joseph remarked, smilingly, ‘Sidney is not used to it as I am.’” (*Juvenile Instructor*, May 1892, 303-4 as quoted in *Doctrine and Covenants Student Manual, Religion 324 and 325*, 158.)

†2. The Prophet Joseph Smith: “I could explain a hundred fold more than I ever have of the glories of the kingdoms manifested to me in the vision, were I permitted, and were the people prepared to receive them.” (*Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, 304)

†3. President Marion G. Romney: “As I have read the scriptures, I have been challenged by the word *ponder*, so frequently used in the Book of Mormon. The dictionary says that *ponder* means ‘to weigh mentally, think deeply about, deliberate, meditate.’ ...

“*Pondering* is, in my feeling a form of prayer. It has, at least, been an approach to the Spirit of the Lord on many occasions.” (“[Magnifying One’s Calling in the Priesthood](#),” *Ensign*, July 1973, 90)

†4. The Prophet Joseph Smith: “What must a man do to commit the unpardonable sin? He must receive the Holy Ghost, have the heavens opened unto him, and know God, and then sin against Him. After a man has sinned against the Holy Ghost, there is no repentance for him. He has got to say the sun does not shine while he sees it; he has got to deny Jesus Christ when the heavens have been opened unto him, and to deny the plan of salvation with his eyes open to the truth of it; and from that time he begins to be an enemy. This is the case with many apostates of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.” (*TPJS*, 358)

†5. President Ezra Taft Benson: “... not to be valiant in one’s testimony is a tragedy of eternal consequence. These are members who know this latter-day work is true, but who fail to endure to the end. Some may even hold temple recommends, but do not magnify their callings in the Church. Without valor, they do not take an affirmative stand for the kingdom of God. Some seek the praise, adulation, and honors of men; others attempt to conceal their sins; and a few criticize those who preside over them.” (*Teachings of Ezra Taft Benson*, 392-93)

†6. Elder Bruce R. McConkie: “To be valiant in the testimony of Jesus is to ‘come unto Christ, and be perfected in him’; it is to deny ourselves ‘of all ungodliness,’ and ‘love God’ with all our ‘might, mind and strength.’ (Moro. 10:32) ...

“To be valiant in the testimony of Jesus is to ‘press forward with a steadfastness in Christ, having a perfect brightness of hope, and a love of God and of all men.’ It is to ‘endure to the end.’ (2 Ne. 31:20.) ... It is the manifestation of ‘pure religion’ in the lives of men; it is visiting ‘the fatherless and the widows in their affliction’ and keeping ourselves ‘unspotted from the world.’ (James 1:27.)

“To be valiant in the testimony of Jesus is to bridle our passions, control our appetites, and rise above carnal and evil things... It is to be morally clean, pay our tithes and offerings, to honor the Sabbath day, to pray with full purpose of heart, to lay our all upon the altar if called upon to do so.

“To be valiant in the testimony of Jesus is to take the Lord’s side on every issue. It is to vote as he would vote. It is to think what he thinks, to believe what he believes, to say what he would say and do what he would do in the same situation. It is to have the mind of Christ and be one with him as he is one with his Father.” (“[Be Valiant in the Fight of Faith](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1974, 35)

†7. The Prophet Joseph Smith: “When you climb up a ladder, you must begin at the bottom, and ascend step by step, until you arrive at the top; and so it is with the principles of the Gospel—you must begin with the first, and go on until you learn all the principles of exaltation. But it will be a great while after you have passed through the veil before you will have learned them. It is not all to be comprehended in this world; it will be a great work to learn our salvation and exaltation even beyond the grave.” (*Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, 348)

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